

Onboarding a brand

Everything needed to take a brand from “yes” to a tracked sale on the dashboard. Part one is for the Pluggz side; part two is for the brand.

There are five steps and only three of them need a person. Allow twenty minutes on our side, and about ten minutes of the brand's developer's time.

Before you start, agree these with the brand in writing

Commission rate · return window · settlement terms · who receives the invoice. They are set once at onboarding and apply to every sale that brand ever makes, so it is worth being exact rather than adjusting later.

1 · Create the brand

Admin → Brands → New.

Field	What it decides
Brand name	What shoppers see on every product card
Website	Their shop. Used to match products pasted by creators
Affiliate programme?	The first question. It decides everything after it
Commission rate	What the brand pays Pluggz on each sale
Return window	How long before a sale is safe to pay out
Attribution window	How long after a click a sale still counts
Settlement terms	How long they have to pay us once verified
Primary contact	Who gets the dashboard invite in step 3

You can type these naturally: “12%”, “21 days”, “30 days after verified” are all read correctly.

The return window is per brand, and it matters

A creator is paid once it passes. Set it to what was actually agreed. too short pays out before the refund risk is over, too long makes people wait for nothing. Thirty days unless the brand says otherwise.

2 · Issue their tracking keys

Admin → Brands → Tracking keys.

This produces two values: a **key** that identifies the brand and a **signing secret** that proves a sale report really came from them.

The secret is shown once and cannot be retrieved

Copy both before leaving the screen. If the secret is lost, issue a new pair, which also stops the old one working, and is how a leaked secret is dealt with. Send them to the brand the same way you would a password: a one-time link, never WhatsApp or plain email.

3 · Invite the brand's contact

Admin → **Brands** → **Invite contact**. Name and email, nothing else.

They receive an email, set their own password, and land on their dashboard. **You never send anyone a password.**

They see their own clicks, sales, conversion rate and what they owe, and nothing else. There is not one editable control on any of their pages, and a brand can only ever see its own figures.

4 · Products go on by themselves

Creators add the brand's products by pasting a product link. The title, image and price come across automatically, and each listing gets its own permanent Pluggz link. Nothing for you to do.

5 · Sales arrive on their own, once step 2 is wired up

When the brand's site confirms an order it tells Pluggz, and the sale appears with commission already calculated. Part two of this document is what their developer needs.

If a brand cannot do the technical step, use **Admin** → **Record sales** to load their CSV report instead, or reconcile a per-creator discount code. Both feed the same engine. It is the fallback, not the plan.

What happens to a sale after that

Stage	What it means
Pending	Recorded. The brand's return window is running
Verified	The window passed. The refund risk is over
Paid to Pluggz	The brand has settled their invoice
Paid to creator	Sent on a payout run: the 1st or the 15th

Two questions that always come up

Can a brand set its own commission rate? No, deliberately. Rates, campaigns and creator contact stay with the Pluggz team.

Can a brand upload products? No. Creators add them by pasting a link, which is what keeps a real review attached to every listing.

For the brand's developer

Telling Pluggz when an order completes. About ten minutes of work, once.

Pluggz sends you shoppers from creators' storefronts. To pay the right creator, we need to know when one of those visits turns into an order. There are two steps and no ongoing effort.

We never want customer data

Do not send names, email addresses, delivery addresses or payment details. We have no use for them and will discard them. All we need is our own reference, your order number and the order value.

Step 1 · Keep our reference when a shopper arrives

Every shopper we send lands on your site with an extra parameter:

`https://yourshop.com/products/...?ref=pluggz&pz=cmsq0k...`

Store the value of pz against that visitor's session or cart (a cookie is fine) and keep it until checkout. It identifies the individual click, so it is what ties an order back to the creator who earned it.

Give it at least the length of the agreed attribution window, thirty days by default. If a shopper arrives with a new pz, overwrite the old one.

Step 2 · Tell us when the order completes

From your server, once the order is confirmed and paid:

POST `https://pluggzofficial.co.uk/api/track/sale`

Content-Type: `application/json`

X-Pluggz-Key: `pz_live_...`

X-Pluggz-Signature: `sha256=<hex>`

```
{ "pz": "cmsq0k...", "orderRef": "1002948", "value": 4499, "currency": "GBP" }
```

Field	Required	Notes
pz	yes	The reference you stored in step 1
orderRef	yes	Your order number. Stops an order counting twice
value	yes	Commissionable value in pence . 4499 = £44.99
currency	no	GBP unless agreed otherwise
soldAt	no	ISO 8601. Defaults to when we receive it

The two things that catch people out

value is in pence, as a whole number. £44.99 is 4499, not 44.99.

Send our pz back exactly as it arrived. Don't trim it, lower-case it or truncate the column it is stored in.

Signing

Sign the exact bytes you send, using the signing secret we gave you:

```
const signature = crypto.createHmac("sha256", SECRET).update(rawBody).digest("hex");
```

Sign the raw body, not a re-serialised object. Re-encoding JSON will not reproduce the same bytes and the signature will not match. This is what stops anyone else claiming sales against your account.

What comes back

Code	Meaning
200	Recorded, or already recorded if you are retrying
401	Key or signature wrong
403	That reference belongs to a different brand
422	We could not match the reference. Still send it , it tells us something is being lost in step 1
429	Too fast. Retry after a short pause

Retries and refunds

- **Retries are safe.** The same order number twice is recorded once, and the reply says so. If your checkout can fire twice, or you retry on a timeout, nothing is double-counted.
- **Refunds and cancellations:** send the same message with "status": "cancelled" and the commission is reversed. In most cases nothing needs clawing back, because a creator is not paid until the return window has passed.

Test it once, before you go live

Ask us for a Pluggz link to one of your products. Click it, complete a real order on your own site, and tell us the order number. We will confirm we received it and that it matched the right creator.

If it didn't arrive, the cause is almost always one of three things: the pz was not kept through checkout, the value was sent in pounds instead of pence, or the signature was computed over re-encoded JSON rather than the raw body.

What you get

- Your own dashboard: shoppers sent, conversion rate, sales, and what you owe
- Which creators are actually driving your sales, not a monthly summary
- Commission on confirmed sales only. Never on clicks, never on impressions

Anything unclear, ask before building it. A ten-minute conversation is cheaper than a month of sales landing in the wrong place.